



Packaging

Giving it the right treatment

Creating an amazing game or application using Unreal Engine 5 is just one part of the development process. To share your project with the world, you need to package it into an executable format that can be run on various platforms. Packaging is the process of compiling and bundling all the necessary files into one comprehensive unit that includes the compiled game code, assets, and any additional files needed by the application. In this guide, we will delve deep into how to package your Unreal Engine 5 projects effectively.

Understanding packaging

Before we go into the details of packaging, let's understand why it is crucial. When you're developing a project in Unreal Engine, you're working in a specialized environment with numerous resources at your disposal. However, the end-users

of your application or game will not have this development environment. Therefore, you need to package the project into a format that can be easily distributed and executed on the target platform.

Unreal Engine 5 uses the concept of “cooking” when packaging projects. Cooking is the process of preparing game content for efficient use at runtime. It converts data formats into something optimized for the platform, like compressing textures and precomputing data.

Preparation before packaging

Before you start the packaging process, there are several things you should check to ensure that your project is ready for packaging.

- **Build Configuration:** Unreal Engine 5 offers several build configurations, each suited for a specific use case. For